

Meeting Prep: Improving + Solace Onsite

Date: Tuesday, July 28, 2026

Time: 12:00 PM – 3:00 PM CDT

Location: Improving Dallas – Classroom (Involvement Room)

Format: Lunch 12–1, Working Session 1–3

The Room

Solace Attendees

Name	Role	Notes
Austin Ledesma	Enterprise Account Director, TOLA (TX, OK, CO, AR, KS)	Primary relationship; organized the onsite. 469.569.0564
Ryan Piper	Partnership/Channel Leader	Existing relationship; originated the outreach. Drove the Energy campaign decision at their QBR.
Laurent Guillot	(Solace)	Looped in by Austin for this onsite
Michael Hilmen	(Solace)	Looped in by Austin for this onsite
Kyle Scott	(Solace)	On calendar invite
Charlie Glick	(Solace)	On calendar invite

Improving Attendees

Name	Role
David O'Hara	Regional Director, Texas (TOLA)
Ehren Seim	Head of Partnerships
Matt Russell	(Improving)
Alice Mburu	Executive Assistant to David

Context & History

How this started: Ryan Piper reached out to Ehren Seim and Matt Russell on July 2 asking who to connect with in the Dallas office for an onsite. Ehren pointed him to David ("@David O'Hara is your guy. He runs TOLA now"). Ryan introduced Austin Ledesma as the Solace TOLA counterpart and the thread escalated quickly into this meeting.

The strategic signal from Solace's QBR: Ryan explicitly said: *"During QBR this week we landed on an Energy campaign. I will provide a list of targets we can work from. I'll also provide some sample reference architectures/use cases to get us started."* This is not exploratory — Solace came into their QBR and came out with Energy as a priority vertical, and they want Improving as the execution partner in TOLA.

Austin's framing: "I'm looking forward to coming out to discuss how we can strengthen the partnership." Solace intends this to be a planning session, not a discovery call. They expect to co-create.

Agenda Solace confirmed: They said they'd *"put together a formal agenda internally and send it over for your team's input/collaboration ahead of time."* Check whether that agenda arrived — if not, that's the first thing to address.

Happy hour follow-on: Austin organized a Solace + Improving happy hour at Whiskey Moon immediately after (4:30–7:00 PM CDT). This is relationship-building time; keep the working session tight so people arrive energized.

What Solace Wants

Based on email context, they are coming with:

- A target account list for the Energy/Utilities vertical in TOLA
- Reference architectures and use cases for Energy (event-driven architecture patterns)
- A desire to define joint go-to-market motion — shared pipeline, co-sell execution, joint marketing

They are not here to pitch Solace. They know Improving already. This is an execution planning session.

What You Should Want to Walk Out With

- A co-sell motion defined: who owns what, how leads get shared, how pipeline is tracked
- A prioritized list of Energy targets to pursue jointly in Q3
- Agreement on 2–3 reference architectures or use cases that Improving can lead delivery on
- Named joint accounts or prospects to pursue first
- A follow-up cadence locked in (standing QBR, shared Slack/Teams channel, etc.)
- Clarity on any joint marketing budget or field events they can fund

Agenda (Austin Ledesma / Solace — confirmed July 27)

Objective: Align on where Solace fits across Improving's account base, identify repeatable plays, and build a joint plan to scale adoption.

Time	Topic
12:00–1:00	Lunch (60 min)
1:00–1:15	Welcome & Partnership Vision — why we're here, mutual growth goals, round of intros (roles + territories/verticals)
1:15–1:40	Solace Overview, Business Value & Outcomes — use cases, success stories, displacement scenarios (legacy MQ/TIBCO, Kafka-only, point-to-point sprawl), EDA as connective layer for SAP modernization, cloud migration, agentic AI
1:40–2:05	Account & Vertical Alignment — map Improving's active accounts against Solace's TOLA verticals (energy, transportation/logistics, retail/CPG, enterprise tech); identify overlap and white space; named accounts below
2:05–2:30	Repeatable Plays — define 2–3 packaged plays (event mesh, OT/IT convergence for energy, agentic AI via SAM/SAP AEM); qualification criteria; joint discovery/pitch motion
2:30–2:50	Scaling & Enablement — what Improving's team needs to sell Solace confidently (training, battlecards, reference architectures); pipeline review cadence; marketing/co-sell opportunities
2:50–3:00	Next Steps & Owners — confirm 3–5 priority accounts, assign action items with owners and dates, set follow-up check-in

Named Accounts in Austin's Agenda

Existing customers Solace wants to interface on:

- **HP Inc.** — TIBCO replacement

- **AT&T** — Legacy modernization
- **ExxonMobil** — SAP modernization and agentic AI (*Improving has active relationship*)
- **SLB** — SAP modernization and agentic AI

Other active Solace customers to discuss: Halliburton, Baker Hughes, Charles Schwab (*Improving has Charles Schwab relationship*)

Prospects to align on: Kinetik (UNS), Alaska Airlines (TIBCO displacement), Avelo Airlines (SWIM)

Note: Solace's scope is broader than energy — they're bringing transportation/logistics (airlines) and enterprise tech too. Come prepared to discuss Improving's full TOLA account base, not just energy accounts.

Questions to Drive the Working Session

- Energy targets:** Which specific companies are on your list? What stage are they at with Solace, and where does Improving fit in the journey?
- Reference architectures:** Which use cases have the most traction right now — SCADA modernization, grid management, real-time trading, something else?
- Co-sell motion:** How does Solace want to track joint pipeline? What does a referred opportunity look like on your side?
- Existing Solace customers in TOLA:** Are there accounts where we should be expanding Solace usage and Improving can lead delivery?
- Marketing:** Is there budget for joint events, roundtables, or content in H2? Who do we talk to on your side?
- Partnerships team:** Who do Ehren and Austin's teams work through day-to-day? Let's get the right contacts connected.

Improving's TOLA Energy Footprint

Current / Recent Engagements

Source: Dynamics 365 CRM — closed-won opportunities pulled July 27, 2026. All accounts have CRM activity within the last 2 years.

Client	HQ	CRM Status	Services Delivered	Last Won Deal
NRG Energy	Houston, TX	Active — multi-year	AI DLP Program (\$1.6M, Apr 2026), embedded Agile coach (Richard Mouser, multi-year renewals ~\$374K/yr), PSM/PSPO training, StrengthFinders, SAP BDC data products, business process optimization	Apr 2026
CP Chem (Chevron Phillips)	The Woodlands, TX	Active — embedded team	Multiple long-term consultants placed (full-stack dev, .NET dev, data engineer), Azure Databricks nearshore, digital transformation workshop, executive workshop (Oklahoma), dev audit	Jun 2026

Client	HQ	CRM Status	Services Delivered	Last Won Deal
Energy Worldnet	Gainesville, TX	Active — AI programs	Agentic AI workshop (Feb 2026), AI Deep Learning Program (\$100K, Apr 2026), QA engineer placement, AI consultant extension (closed today, Jul 27)	Jul 2026
Newmont USA	Denver / TX ops	Active — SAP analytics	Multi-phase SAP Reporting & Analytics for supply chain (\$3M+), Newcrest acquisition integration, Power BI & Datasphere resources, SAP Concur dashboard	Jun 2026
EnergyHub	Brooklyn, NY / TOLA clients	Active — dedicated team	Embedded Java/Python engineering team (5–15 engineers), annual renewals ~\$450–500K/yr since 2023	Jan 2026
Venture Global LNG	Arlington, VA / Gulf Coast ops	Active — SAP/analytics	SAP Analytics Cloud (SAC) report creation, planning enhancements, GR enhancements, 9-entity expansion, support model — ongoing since 2023	Jun 2026
Oceaneering	Houston, TX	Active — security & architecture	SOC 2 Type 2 consulting, risk assessment, penetration testing, architecture consulting	Jun 2026
ExxonMobil	Irving, TX	Active — training & staffing	Full dev team placement (C#/WPF, Upstream Research, ~\$2.7M), multiple PSPO and PSM training cohorts	Oct 2024
Nabors Corporate Services	Houston, TX	Active — DevOps & training	DevOps consulting, Azure DevOps governance and training, Microsoft training	Aug 2025
CPower	TX / national	Active — consulting & staffing	Platform engineer, data scientist, Azure/DevOps engineers, Angular UI dev, API architect, agile coaching, Azure migration	Jan 2026
Kodiak Gas Services	Montgomery, TX	Early — training	ASI training with launch workshop (\$17K, Nov 2025)	Nov 2025
Archrock	Houston, TX	Active (no won opps yet)	CRM activity confirms relationship; no closed-won deals on record	—

Client	HQ	CRM Status	Services Delivered	Last Won Deal
Charles Schwab	Westlake, TX	Active — L&D staffing	Long-running instructional design team (5+ consultants placed including Shel, Joe, Julie King, Andraya); steady annual renewals since 2023; ~\$1.5M+ in placements	Jun 2026
American Airlines	Fort Worth, TX	Active — engineering staffing	Large embedded Java/full-stack engineering team on Customer Loyalty platform (React, Angular, Spring Boot, Azure); squad leads, senior devs, Agile coaches; multiple multi-year renewals; one SOW alone worth \$7.6M	Dec 2025
Southwest Airlines	Dallas, TX	In CRM — no won opps	CRM record exists (last activity Jun 2024) but no closed-won opportunities on record	—

Strategic Energy Prospects — TOLA (Research-Backed)

Source: Mind/One Texas/Texas Research (Copilot).md — ranked by Improving's strategic fit criteria

Company	HQ	Rank	Digital Initiative	Why Relevant for Solace
ExxonMobil	Irving, TX	High	AI-driven digital backbone (partnership with Cerebre); redomiciled to Texas	Massive scale, deep Texas presence, integration complexity = EDA use case
Baker Hughes	Houston, TX	Medium	Cloud-based drilling analytics + AI visualization (Corva partnership)	Data streaming across field operations; strong Solace fit
Schlumberger (SLB)	Houston, TX	Medium	OSDU data platform with AWS + Shell	Subsurface data workflows, hybrid cloud = EDA infrastructure need
Vistra Corp	Irving, TX	Low	Distributed energy + battery aggregation (Sunrun/Voltus)	Growing digital footprint; McKinsey Digital engagement signals spend
Sunnova Energy	Houston, TX	Low	AI-powered solar design tools; Adaptive Technology Center	Smaller scale but innovative; energy management use cases

Ranking based on: Strategic Vendor Alignment (40%), Investment Scale (30%), Regional Expansion (20%), Industry Growth Potential (10%)

Note on xAI / TOLA Overlap

Your June 2026 conversation with Cole Estrate (xAI) confirmed that xAI's top TOLA verticals are **oil and gas, industrial manufacturing, and financial services** — the same verticals Solace is targeting. An account mapping session was planned between xAI and Improving. If that hasn't happened, this meeting is a good forcing function to get that done — a three-way Improving/Solace/xAI co-sell motion in Energy could be differentiated.

